

Bleed blue: After the HIL, Deepika rejoined India for the FIH Pro League 2024-25, where it stunned the Olympic champion Netherlands in a shootout after a 2-2 draw. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



international tournament, and a function was held for her at the SAI Centre. We all welcomed her with garlands. The coach told us about her journey, even though her career had only just begun. It was an emotional moment, and I wanted to experience the same," Deepika recalled. She finally had her moment when she returned to the same ground in Hisar after the Women's HIL – the first of many such instances to come.

A special goal

Soon after the HIL, Deepika returned to international duty for India's FIH Pro League 2024-25 campaign in February.

India stunned reigning World and Olympic champions the Netherlands in a penalty shootout after a 2-2 draw in Bhubaneswar. Despite trailing 0-2 at half-time, India's more aggressive style under new coach Harendra Singh, who replaced

Schopman, turned the match around. Five minutes into the second half, Deepika scored a sensational solo goal, a moment that quickly went viral, garnering over 31,700 views on X.

Receiving a pass from Sunelita Toppo just after being subbed in, Deepika surged down the left flank. Within 10 seconds, she entered the shooting circle, deftly lifted the ball over a defender's stick, and scooped it past the onrushing Dutch goalkeeper Josine Koning into the top-right corner.

In that electrifying sequence, Deepika displayed her fitness, game awareness, and decision-making.

With the second leg of the Pro League (June 14-29 in Europe) and the Asia Cup (dates and venue to be announced) approaching, where World Cup qualification spots will be at stake, Deepika's form bodes well for Indian women's hockey.



Age: 21

Position: Forward

Matches: 56

Goals: 27 (Penalty Corners - 14, Field Goals - 9, Penalty Strokes - 4)

Debut: Against China in FIH Pro League on January 31, 2022

Maiden goal: Against Singapore in Hangzhou Asian Games on September 27, 2023

Most goals in a match: Five against Thailand in Asian Champions Trophy, Rajgir, on November 14, 2024

Major Achievements -

Bronze medal at Hangzhou Asian Games 2023

Gold medals at Asian Champions Trophy (2023 and 2024)

Bronze medal at Asia Cup 2022